Issue	Release-blocking for v8.0.0-rc.1?	Owner	Disposition
#525 release:preflight was a silent no-op	No — fixed on this release commit	maintainer	The defect is repaired and covered by tests/cycles/DX-052/release-metadata-entrypoint.test.ts. The issue stays open for the residual suggestion that Verify release candidate should fail when it emits no outputs, rather than letting a downstream job discover the emptiness.
#526 lock-step versioning ignores package-lock.json	No — the symptom is fixed on this release commit	maintainer	The lockfile is regenerated and consistent at 8.0.0-rc.1. The three gates that failed to detect it are unchanged, so the class of defect remains and could recur on the next bump. Accepted for a prerelease; should be closed before the stable tag, since a stale lock is exactly the kind of thing a GA must not ship. See residual risk 2.
#527 replay inherited witnesses	Blocking for 8.0.0, accepted for the rc	maintainer	The rc's purpose is downstream validation of #518's breaking changes, which does not depend on re-proving three unrelated goalposts. Carries the six unreviewed human-review surfaces too.